

Is AI worth the harm to the environment?

Posted by u/beuef • 0 points • 24 comments

Do you guys think it's worth it given the rising energy usage by AI as time goes on and the already increasing global temperature

Comments

u/Patient_Somewhere922 • 3 points • 2024-09-30 05:21 UTC

Could you imagine backing off on progressing in a technological advancement as impactful as AGI because of energy consumption

I doubt we even use a fraction of the energy China's clunker oil tankers chug spewing all that putrid slop into the atmosphere, let's just go big at this point

u/chris_paul_fraud • 1 points • 2024-09-30 07:17 UTC

Right, it's China's oil tankers that are keeping us in this mess 🤔

u/Patient_Somewhere922 • 0 points • 2024-09-30 07:26 UTC

Best reading comprehension on reddit:

u/chris_paul_fraud • 1 points • 2024-09-30 08:03 UTC

It's goofy to single out China when they use 3/4's of the oil the US does

u/Patient_Somewhere922 • 0 points • 2024-09-30 14:58 UTC

Please for the love of God just read what I said, how is Reddit reading comprehension this awful? How is that your takeaway?

u/sdmat • 3 points • 2024-09-30 04:34 UTC

Energy use isn't harm to the environment. Those are two very separate things, conflating them as you do here is dirty sophistry.

All the hyperscalers have put a ton of money into carbon neutral energy and are ramping up hard on solar and nuclear.

u/COD_ricochet • 4 points • 2024-09-30 04:13 UTC

Anyone with average intelligence understands this factoid:

AI is the only thing that could save humanity from cataclysmic environmental change.

We should be utilizing ALL available sources of energy to push AI to advance as fast as possible. It is the fastest way to actually SAVE the environment. As ironic as it sounds.

u/petermobeter • -1 points • 2024-09-30 03:47 UTC

i dont think the tech folks here realize how much the energy usage for a.i. is

i heard one a.i. company (i forget if its microsoft or not) is gonn need more power for their planned A.I. than the USA produces, so theyre looking into buying land in canada to make up the difference

u/beuef • 1 points • 2024-09-30 03:48 UTC

I can't find an answer outside of just "AI will fix it" as if the concern is just completely unfounded. And mind you I'm a fan of AI

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2024-09-30 03:24 UTC

[deleted]

u/cloudrunner69 • 3 points • 2024-09-30 03:22 UTC

Are cars worth the harm to environment, or cruise ships, or smartphones, or potato chips?

u/beuef • 1 points • 2024-09-30 03:23 UTC

Cars and cruise ships and potato chips no

u/zeaor • 3 points • 2024-09-30 04:12 UTC

I believe their point is that every novel technology uses energy. So your argument is against scientific progress in general.

If you can't be bothered to google the advances in biology, linguistics, art, and just general productivity that AI has brought, that's on you.

u/goldenwind207 • 4 points • 2024-09-30 03:08 UTC

AI isn't the main cause of climate change not by a longshot. And if we can use it to build say nuclear fusion it will be more then worth it

u/printr_head • -3 points • 2024-09-30 03:19 UTC

Came here to laugh at comments like this. Its almost like Sam knew he would be believed.

u/micaroma • 5 points • 2024-09-30 03:42 UTC

Do you think Sam is the first prominent person to suggest that AI can help solve the climate crisis? wtf?

u/goldenwind207 • 5 points • 2024-09-30 03:24 UTC

Whats so unbelievable about what i stated. Climate change is primarily caused by oil natural gas home appliances like ac food production etc.

If you mean nuclear fusion i don't see why thats impossible demis said a similar thing. If you believe agi is possible then its pretty reasonable if not then it's a waste of time. And nothing so far has shown me agi is not possible

u/printr_head • -6 points • 2024-09-30 03:26 UTC

Nothing is unbelievable about it except it wasn't a thought until he brought it up.

He started taking heat for the waste and then provide an excuse and now its justification.

u/IlustriousTea • 6 points • 2024-09-30 02:40 UTC

Blaming AI for the climate crisis isn't fair at all when bigger contributors like fossil fuels and deforestation are at fault. AI is actually at the forefront of solutions, optimizing energy, enhancing climate models, and driving sustainable innovation.

u/After_Sweet4068 • 3 points • 2024-09-30 02:48 UTC

Dont forget about forest fires....I live in brazil and we are having a huge wave of criminal fire here. I have video proof of a fucking flame tornado 1km from my house. Humans are the poison, we can only hope AI to help with the shitty situation we put ourselves as humanity

u/hallowed_by • -1 points • 2024-09-30 02:33 UTC

Breeder nuclear reactors make it quite harmless.

We don't even need the AI to make some breakthrough in energy - we've done it ourselves. Just have to remove all the delusional hippies from the decision making equation and we are all set.

u/Temp_Placeholder • 3 points • 2024-09-30 02:22 UTC

They keep increasing the efficiency of inference, both for LLMs and image generation.

Granted, then they spend that efficiency increase on bigger models or chain of thought, so they aren't decreasing their power footprint, but increasing what we get from it. We've got at least another 100 fold power reduction for inference coming just from ASICs.

So, at the very least, some level of AI around today's level is 'worth it', in that if we stopped trying to increase its capacities than very shortly the energy cost would be negligible. And if we do keep increasing its capacity? Then it'll be instrumental in solving many practical problems for us, like clean energy.

u/RantyWildling • 9 points • 2024-09-30 02:20 UTC

Short of living like we're back in the stone age, we're not going to slow down our emissions fast enough, so it makes sense to be an accelerationist.

If we get fusion reactors, AI will have been worth it.